

Wardriving

The unauthorised act of seeking out and mapping wireless access points (APs) that are available for free network access, such as those at a coffee house or an airport, or an office AP with a leaky signal. This is the new, wireless version of war dialling, in which hackers would dial hundreds of numbers to find an open modem so that they could gain access to a company's network. See also warchalking.

WECA

Wireless Ethernet Compatibility Alliance. This is the former name of the Wi-Fi Alliance of vendors promoting 802.11 wireless networking standards and compatibility.

WEP

Wired Equivalent Privacy. All 802.11b (Wi-Fi) networks use WEP as their basic security protocol. WEP secures data transmissions using 64-bit or 128-bit encryption; however, it does not offer complete security, and is usually used in conjunction with other security measures such as EAP.

Wi-Fi

Wireless Fidelity. Wi-Fi originally referred to the 802.11b specification for wireless LANs, but it is now used to describe any of the 802.11 wireless networking specifications.

Wireless Bridging

A networking bridge is used to connect two or more separate networks. A wireless bridge functions the same way but can be used in situations in which running a wire or cable would be impractical or prohibitively expensive, such as creating a 10-mile point-to-point link.

Wireless Channel

Different networking technologies divide up their allocated spectrum in different ways. One can sometimes improve the performance of your network and avoid interference on the band by